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A. Purpose: To provide guidelines instruction for management of situation wherein their is a shortage of bed in the hospital**.**

B. Scope: Hospital Wide

C. Responsibility: Medical Superintendent and Chief Medical Officer

D. Policy:

- Patients are admitted to the hospital through the emergency department and also the out patient department.
- All patients reaching the emergency department are provided with first aid and all available life saving measures.
- Patients are then transferred to the respective in patient departments (wards) after being seen and advised by the consultant.
- Patients seen in outpatient departments by the consultant are advised admission based on the clinical conditions.
- In case of non-availability of beds inside the inpatient care wards , patients are placed in the emergency ward till the beds are available as per the entitlement.
- Once any bed becomes vacant in the entitled category, patients are shifted to their entitled class, after filling up the transfer form through admission desk.
- In case of absolute non-availability of beds, the hospital will take the initiative to transfer the patients to the nearest hospital or medical college by Hope hospital ambulance accompanied by a nurse or a doctor depending on the need.
- Beds are categorized into semi private wards and private wards.

Type of admission

- **Stable admission:**

If a bed is not available at the time of admission, the patient's relative are made aware of the alternative choices in the hospital.
The staff should make a call to the nearest hospital and ask whether the bed is available or not.
If the Patient is ready to go to the hospital , inform the hospital that the patient is being referred (tell name of the patient)
Guide the patient about how to go to the hospital, make sure that one relative accompany the patient while going.
Give the OPD assessment sheet to the patient.

- **Unstable admission:**

Emergency patient should be taken in the casualty immediately.
Give the patient resuscitation needed for life saving.
Arrange the hospital ambulance and refer the patient immediately to the other hospital.
Give the patient summary and reports if any.
Make a call to the hospital that the patient is coming (tell name of the patient)